HACK876 × UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Connectivity, put to work by young Jamaicans.

The USF connects Jamaicans and invests in the skills to use that access. Hack876 is one day where secondary-school students do exactly that, building real things on a reliable connection.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY THE USF

The USF connects Jamaicans and funds the skills to use that access, including through its ICT Education Grant.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Information on the ICT Education Grant that we can pass to older students. We are testing the venue's Wi-Fi first, and would ask about temporary connectivity only if that shows a gap.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Students who could use the grant hear about it, and every team can work online if the venue needs help.

WHAT THE USF RECEIVES

In-kind recognition and a written recap.

THE NEXT STEP

A reply on what grant information we may share. If the venue test shows a gap, we will write formally to the CEO with the details.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

01 THE REQUEST

What we are asking for, and how it would be used.

This keeps the request simple for a public agency. Connectivity support would follow only if the venue needs it.

- ✓ **Information on the ICT Education Grant for older students**
- ✓ **Temporary event connectivity, only if the venue test shows a gap**

QUANTITIES, TIMING AND DELIVERY

Grant information: whatever the USF already publishes, for us to hand to students and teachers.

Connectivity: the venue is a hotel with its own network. We will test it for about 80 students working at once before asking for anything.

No funding and no staff time on the day are requested.

WHY THE USF

The USF, an agency under the Ministry of Energy, Transport and Telecommunications, is mandated to bridge the digital divide by ensuring Jamaicans have access to ICT.[2]

For 25 years the USF has run the ICT Education Grant Programme, including an Emerging Digital Leaders Grant for people aged 17 to 28.[2]

The USF supports ICT clubs in more than 35 secondary schools, alongside free public Wi-Fi and Community Access Points.[3]

WHAT THE USF WOULD RECEIVE

In-kind Partner · Inaugural Hack876

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

02 DELIVERY AND NEXT DECISION

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Anthropic Claude Ambassador) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 1 confirmed, 2 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A reply on what grant information we may share. If the venue test shows a gap, we will write formally to the CEO with the details.

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We do not report reach, impressions or leads, and we do not share student contact details.

03 APPENDIX

Sources.

SOURCES

1. Universal Service Fund, "Management Team." usf.gov.jm/management-team/

2. Jamaica Observer, "USF puts $3m behind Jamaica's next generation of digital talent (September 26, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/09/26/usf-puts-3m-behind-jamaicas-next-generation-digital-talent/

3. Jamaica Information Service, "Young People Encouraged to Leverage Technology to Develop Innovative Solutions (September 16, 2026)." jis.gov.jm/young-people-encouraged-to-leverage-technology-to-develop-innovative-solutions/

4. Jamaica Observer, "Winners announced for USF's Crack the Code competition (December 18, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/12/18/winners-announced-usfs-crack-code-competition/

5. Universal Service Fund (LinkedIn), "Official Connectivity Partner for the JISA event." www.linkedin.com/posts/usfjamaica_usf-connect2progress-jisa-activity-7453084003647217665-FWdh

6. Jamaica Information Service, "Sixteen Schools Launch USF ICT Clubs (November 11, 2023)." jis.gov.jm/sixteen-schools-launch-usf-ict-clubs/

7. Jamaica Observer, "USF to expand Jamaica's digital infrastructure in 2026/27 (March 3, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/03/03/usf-expand-jamaicas-digital-infrastructure-2026-27/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Charlton McFarlane, Chief Executive Officer, Universal Service Fund.